

you're done editing your menu, move on to the final step: choose a folder where you want to save the converted video files, select the video format (PAL or NTSC), and hit Start.

8.3 Going Online

The best way to get noticed these days (apart from going to an airport and saying "I have a bomb") is to get online. The best way to share your video is to get online. Now you're obviously not going to sit and courier your holiday video to all your aunts and uncles around the country. The best way to get them to watch it is by uploading it to one of several popular video servers that will host your video for free.

It's fast, it's free, and it's easy. But before you go gung-ho uploading videos everywhere, there are a few things you should know.

8.3.1 Making Your Video Bandwidth-Friendly

Some things are really obvious—like you can't insert a three-pin plug into a two-pin socket. Like you can't play cricket with a tennis racquet. Like you can't upload a 1 GB video to YouTube without having to either stay up all night (and all day) or without having a T3 connection. Like you can't expect anyone to really watch such a long video on YouTube in that case, can you?

Fear not. If you have a really heavy video file that you want to upload, making it bandwidth-friendly is easy.

Using Windows Movie Maker

One of the easiest tools to make your video bandwidth-friendly is Windows' very own Movie Maker. Essentially, by "bandwidth-friendly," we mean a video that is not too heavy in terms of file size, and of a resolution that is Net-friendly. For example, YouTube recommends that videos should be 320 x 240. This means that, for example, if your video is 1 GB in weight and more than 640 x 480 pixels in size, then you're going to have some serious cutting to do.